

manufacture them.” Almost every engineering college today, including the IITs and NITs, offer mechatronics in their UG/PG programme.

Talking about the scope at his organisation, Sudhir Reddy shares, “Majority of the freshers at Jay Robotix are required to work on areas such as embedded systems engineering roles, mechanical design roles, software programmer roles, design engineers roles and other electronics engineering roles. We recruit interns with practical attitude and offer roles which will help them realise their potential strengths. The student will be given a permanent role based on the performance. We believe in making it interesting for the students/graduates while on the job.”

To design and develop products in the mechatronics domain in India, 27 per cent engineers are hired by the engineering/manufacturing sector as per TimesJobs’ statistics. Thirteen per cent work in the consumer durable/FMCG sector, 12 per cent in the software industry, 11 per cent in the hardware industry and 9 per cent in construction/cement/steel industry. Remaining 28 per cent are scattered amongst the other industries.

Talking about the top functional areas and geographical locations where mechatronics engineers are hired in India, Vivek Madhukar, COO, TBSL (which operates TimesJobs.com) explains, “People with cross-functional engineering skills are highly sought after across industries, particularly in the manufacturing and engineering, FMCG and IT sectors. In terms of the location of these jobs, the three cities, i.e., Bangalore, Mumbai and Chennai together account for almost

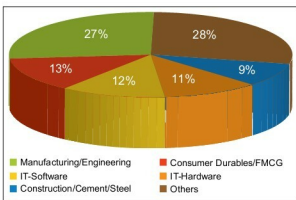


Fig. 1: Top 5 industries hiring mechatronic professionals (Data Courtesy: TimesJobs.com)

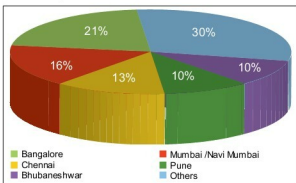


Fig. 2: Top 5 geographical locations hiring mechatronic professionals (Data Courtesy: TimesJobs.com)

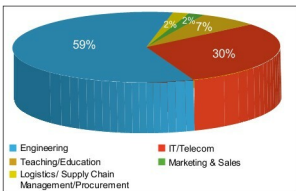


Fig. 3: Verticals where mechatronic professionals are hired (Data Courtesy: TimesJobs.com)

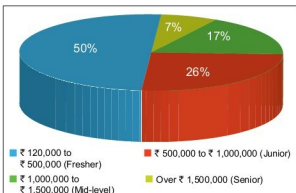


Fig. 4: Percentage of jobs for particular salary range (Data Courtesy: TimesJobs.com)

50 per cent. This is not surprising considering the concentration of electro-mechanical and IT industries in these areas.” Adding to that, Pune and Bhubaneswar, each share about 10 per cent of the engineers working in the mechatronics sector. And apart from the engineering and IT sectors, 7 per cent of the mechatronics professionals are into the teaching/education domain. A mere 2 per cent of each are into marketing/sales and logistics/supply chain management/procurement sectors.

## A good future

Sudhir Reddy says, “According to IFR-International Federation of Robotics—robotics will create one million jobs by 2016 in consumer electronics industry, energy industry, automotive, SME and robotics industry itself. Keeping aside the jobs part, I suggest young graduates to take path of their interest. If it is mechatronics, they should be focussed and it will be highly rewarding.” Career opportunities in the domain of mechatronics are ceaseless, as the job requires a broad range of specialist skills that are in demand across many different industry sectors.

Be strong in the fundamental subjects, particularly those covered in the first two years of the engineering course before diving into core mechatronics subjects/projects, notes Dr Saha. He adds, “In addition, take up projects which are interdisciplinary in nature. For example, there is a Robocon India competition every year organised by Doordarshan. Students participating in that or similar competitions are certainly doing mechatronics.” ●

The author is a senior technical correspondent at EY Bengaluru